2 Digital literacy: Make a web page

You will learn

- how to act respectfully when using a computer
- how to create a simple web page with text and images
- how to review and improve your web pages.

The world wide web (also called the 'web') is an important part of our lives. It gives us information that we need to work, learn and enjoy our leisure time. Anyone can create a web page. A web page lets you share your knowledge and experiences with people across the world. In this unit, you will learn how to create a web page.



Talk about...

What is respectful behaviour? How does respectful behaviour in the classroom make it easier for people to learn?

Should you behave any differently when using computers than you would in everyday life?



Learning outcomes: Create a simple web page with text and images; Review web content you have created to check if appropriate, and amend if needed; Act responsibly and with respect for others when using the computer



Class activity

web page logo
heading image link menu
web page editor respect
be safe

Look at these images of web pages. One is the first web page every created. The other is a modern web page. Can you spot which is which?

- How have websites changed since the web was invented in 1995?
- Do you think they have changed for the better?

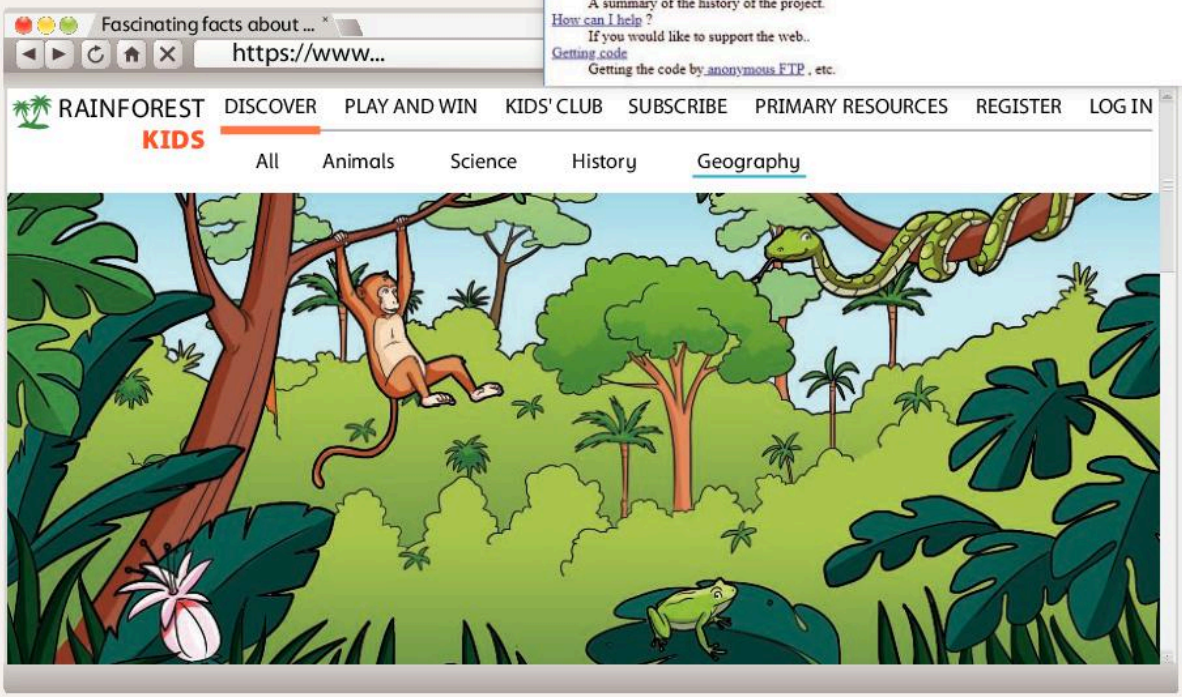


World Wide Web

The WorldWideWeb (W3) is a wide-area hypermedia information retrieval initiative aiming to give universal access to a large universe of documents.

Everything there is online about W3 is linked directly or indirectly to this document, including an executive summary of the project, Mailing lists , Policy , November's W3 news , Frequently Asked Questions .

What's out there?
Pointers to the world's online information, subjects , W3 servers, etc.
Help
on the browser you are using
Software Products
A list of W3 project components and their current state. (e.g. Line Mode ,X11 Viola , NeXTStep , Servers , Tools , Mail robot , Library)
Technical
Details of protocols, formats, program internals etc
Bibliography
Paper documentation on W3 and references.
People
A list of some people involved in the project.
History
A summary of the history of the project.
How can I help ?
If you would like to support the web..
Getting code
Getting the code by anonymous FTP , etc.



Did you know?

The world wide web was invented in 1991. The very first web page has been saved. Look at the web page info.cern.ch and click on the first link in the list you see on the page. It is called 'Browse the first website'.

When you visit the site, you see the entire world wide web as it was in 1991. Today, there are nearly two billion websites!

2.1 Be a respectful computer user

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how responsible behaviour in the classroom makes it a better place to learn
- how being respectful is important when using the internet.

Making the classroom a better place to learn

Using computers for learning is fun. The classroom is a much better place to learn when we behave with respect. You should always behave respectfully towards your teacher and classmates. You should treat equipment with care. Remember, someone else will need to use the equipment after you have finished with it.

This unit gives you a general guide to behaving in the right way when using computers. Your school will have its own rules. Make sure you know them.

Behave respectfully towards your teacher

Working on computer projects often means you work on your own or in small groups. There will be times when your teacher needs to talk to the class. When this happens, stop typing and turn to face your teacher.

Rules for sharing computers and equipment

Remember that you are sharing computers and equipment with other students. Make sure equipment is tidy and in its correct place when you have finished using it. Here are some general rules:

- Be patient and take turns when sharing equipment.
- Do not use equipment for longer than you need to.
- Do not adjust equipment without permission.
- Tell your teacher if equipment is broken or needs attention.
- Leave equipment as you find it.
- Keep your work area tidy. Don't eat or drink at your computer. A spilled drink can be dangerous near electrical equipment.



Being responsible when using online technology

Online behaviour

- Be polite. Think about how you would feel if you received the email or message. Talk to people online as though you are face to face.
- Report anything you see that is frightening or upsetting.
- Help others to report problems.
- Report any behaviour that seems dangerous.

Be safe and help others to stay safe

If a classmate is having a problem using a software application or writing a program, it is good to help. If you are asked, offer an explanation but don't take over. Do not touch your classmate's computer. You could make the problem worse. Offer a solution and let your friend solve the problem.



Activity

Look at the picture of the untidy work area. How do you expect the computer room to look when you arrive to start your class? What problems does an untidy work area cause? List examples where you have found it difficult to work because of damaged or missing computer equipment.





Extra challenge

Work with a partner. Sit at the computer and ask your partner to help you with a problem. For example, you could ask them to explain how to create a new folder.

Let your partner explain the task and help you.

Then discuss how helpful your partner was. Were you confused at any point? Could your partner have explained anything better?

Now change positions so that you offer the help.

Think again

You notice a student is upset by something they have seen on-screen. How could you help them?

2.2 The parts of a web page

In this lesson

You will learn:

- to identify the parts that make up a web page.

Later in this unit you will create your own **web page**. Before you do that, think about what a web page is. What parts – or components – does it contain? The main web page components are shown below.

Components of a web page



Headings: These are short descriptions that tell you what a web page or text is about. **A heading** is larger than normal text so that it stands out.

Images: Most websites use **images** as well as text. Images can be photographs, drawings or cartoons. Images make a web page more interesting and easier to understand.

Links: When you click a **link** on a web page, you leave the page you are on and go to a new page. You use links to find new information on a subject. Links are also called hyperlinks. A hyperlink can be text or an image.

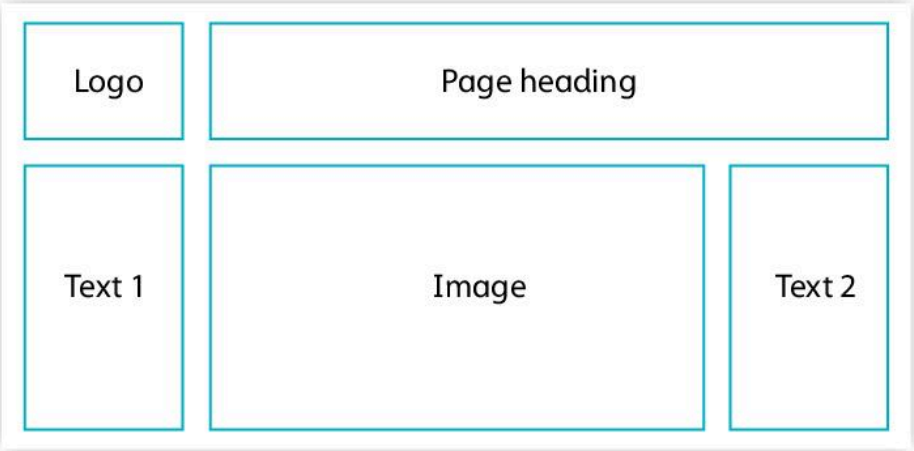
Logo: Most websites use a **logo**. The logo tells you who owns the website. If the website is owned by a company, the company logo will usually be at the top of the web page.

Menu: A **menu** helps you to find your way around the web pages that make up a website. Clicking on a menu option takes you directly to another part of the website.

Text: Text is used on a web page to give information or instructions. Text should be clear and relevant to the subject of the page. Too much text can put off a reader by making a page difficult to read.

Designing a web page

Before you start to create a web page, make a plan. Draw a simple outline plan showing how the components will fit together. Start with a rectangle to represent the computer screen. Then divide the rectangle into smaller sections to show where you will put images, text, and so on. This type of design is called a **wireframe**.





Activity

Your school wants to add a new page to its website. The page will tell parents about a new gymnasium that is being built. The page should include the school logo, a picture showing what the new gym will look like and text describing the gym. Design the page using a wireframe.



Extra challenge

You need to make some changes to your web page design. The design should now include the school logo, two images – showing the inside and outside of the gym, text describing the gym and a heading for the page.



Be creative

Some internet company logos have become very well known.

Design a logo that you can use on your website.

Think again

Open a web page that you use regularly at home or for school work. Identify examples of the six components of a web page.

2.3 Create a web page

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to create a web page
- how to add text to a web page.

Web page editor

You use an application called a **web page editor** to create web pages.

Your teacher will tell you which web page editor to use at school. There are free web page editors that you can use at home. This unit uses a web page editor called Wix. Ask permission from an adult before using web editing software at home.

Sections of a web page

A web page has three sections.

Header: An area at the top of a web page. The header is used for a logo and the name of your web page.

Body: The main part of your web page. It contains the text and images you want to share.

Footer: An area at the bottom of the web page. If you look at the bottom of most web pages, you will see that the footer is used for links to site documents and policies. You won't use a footer in this unit.

Getting started

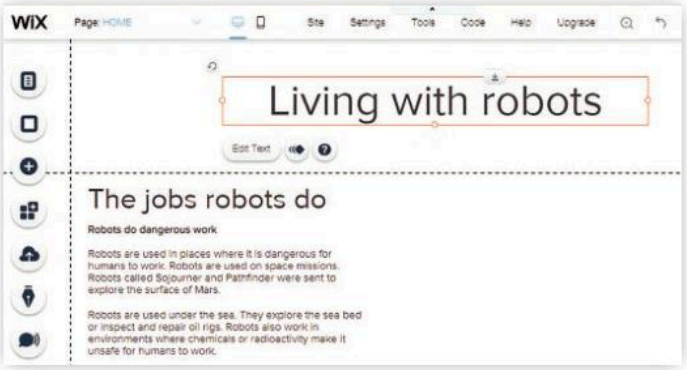
When you open your web page editor for the first time, you will be asked to create a new website. When you create the site, you will be asked to select a template for your site. Choose a blank template. Using a blank template will make it easier for you to learn the basics of web page design.

Adding text to your page

1. Choose the 'Add' option from the toolbar on the left of the screen.
2. Choose 'Text' from the 'Add' menu.
3. Choose a paragraph style from the list if you want to add text. Or choose a heading style to add a heading.
4. A box will appear on your web page. Drag the box to the position you want it on your page. Then type your text inside it.

An example web page

Here is an example of a web page. Notice that the main page heading, 'Living with robots', is above the dotted line. This means it is in the header. The rest of the text is in the body of the page – below the dotted line.



Activity

Design your own web page. It can be about robots or any other topic you choose. Choose a title for your page. Draw a wireframe plan that will show where you will place headings, text and images.



Be safe and responsible

When you publish a web page it can be read by anyone in the world. Do not include personal details on your web page. You must keep your full name, your address and phone number private. Do not include any information that will allow someone to identify or locate you.

Activity

Use a web page editor to create your web page. Add a page title, and text with a heading.

Extra challenge

Add a text box to your web page with the heading 'Did you know?' Do some research and add an interesting fact about your subject in the text box.

Think again

How many types of heading are used in the example web page? Why are some headings larger than others?

Digital citizen of the future

People often use websites to find out information. Others share information through their websites and social media pages. How will you use the web to share your knowledge in the future?

2.4 Add images to your web page

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to add images to a web page.

Spiral back

Last year, you learned that it is important to respect copyright when using other people's content. You should only use content on your web pages if you have permission. A tool like Wix will provide you with images that you can use. You also learned how to find and use Creative Commons images. If you are in any doubt about copyright, ask your teacher.

Choosing the right images

Adding an image to a web page makes the page more interesting. It can also make the web page easier to understand. Make sure you choose images that work with the text on your web page.

Be safe and responsible

Be careful about the images you add to web pages. For example, do not add photos of yourself. If you feel there is a good reason to add an image of yourself, talk to an adult first. Never include images of friends or family without their permission.

An example web page

In the last lesson, you learned how to add text and headings to a web page. The 'Living with robots' example showed you how to position text and headings in the body and header of a web page.

Here is what the 'Living with robots' web page looks like when images are added. Two images have been added to the page. A logo has been added to the left of the web page heading. The logo is in the page header. An image has been added to the right of the text, in the body of the page.



How to add images to a web page

Here are the steps to follow to insert an image on your own web page. Remember, the web page editor used in this book is Wix. If you are using a different web page, menus and tool bars might be slightly different.

1 Choose the 'Add an Image' option from the tool bar on the left of the screen.

2 Use the 'Free Wix Images' option for this activity.

3 Select an image you want to add to your page.

4 Resize the image. Drag it into position.





Activity

Open the web page you created in the last lesson.

Add an image to the body of your page. Choose an image that works with the text on the page.



Extra challenge

In the last lesson you added a 'Did you know?' section to your web page.

Search the web for a suitable image for this section. Add the image to the 'Did you know?' section.

Think again

Here are two paragraphs from a web page about robots. Which image (A, B or C) would you choose to illustrate each paragraph?

- A robot arm has joints. The joints twist and bend like those in a human arm. A robot arm can do jobs that humans do with their arms.
- Robots are used to make cars. In a car factory, robots work together in teams. Each robot does its own job in turn.

A



B



C



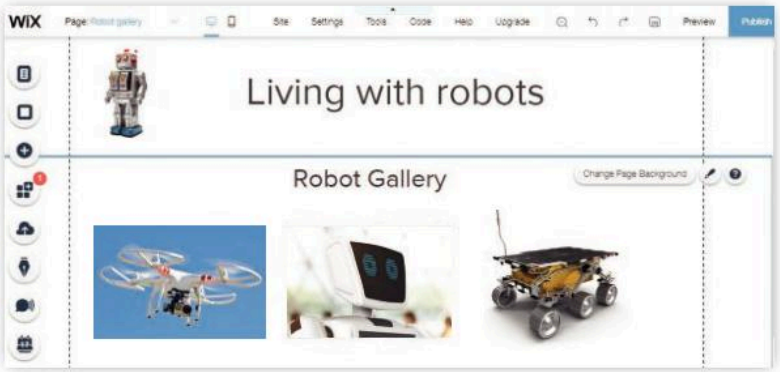
2.5 Add a new web page

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to add a new web page to a website
- how to add a menu to a web page.

In this lesson you will add another web page to your 'Living with robots' website. This web page will be called 'Robot gallery'.

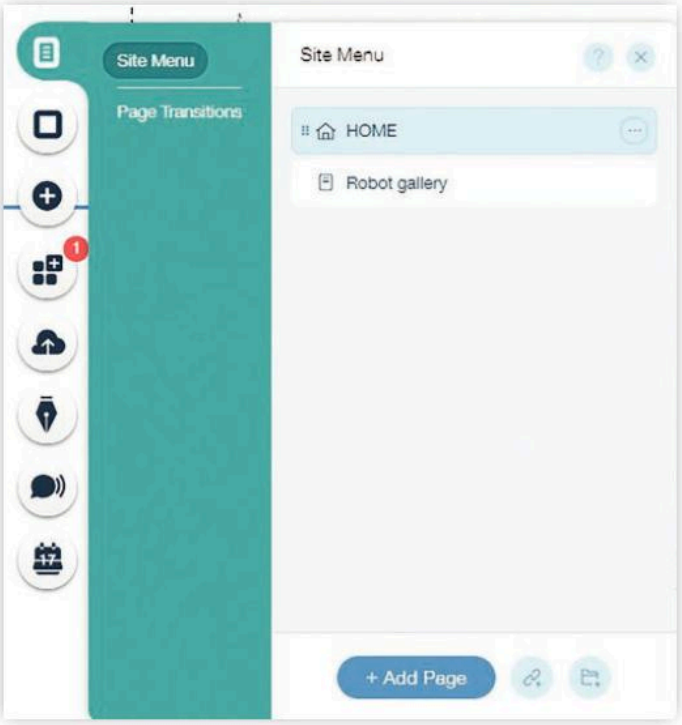


How to add a new web page

Here is how to add a new web page.

1. Choose the 'Menus and Pages' option from the tool bar on the left-hand side of the screen.
2. Click 'Add page' at the bottom of the screen.
3. Type in a name for your new page (our example is 'Robot gallery').

If you want to move between pages in the web page editor, choose the 'Menus and pages' option. Click on a page name to go to that page.



Your website

Your home page

You should see two web pages listed on the site menu – 'Home' and 'Robot gallery'.

A collection of web pages is called a website. You have now created a website! The first page you create is always called 'Home'. It is the home page. The home page is what people see first when they visit a website.

The page header

When you created the home page, you added the name of the web page and a logo in the page header.

When you create a new page, the information in the home page header is automatically inserted in the header of the new page.

How to link pages

When someone visits your website, they arrive at the home page. If you want your visitors to see 'Robot gallery', you must create a link to that page. Visitors click on the web link to visit your gallery. There are several ways to link from one page to another. In this lesson you will use a menu.

How to add a menu to a web page

1 Choose 'Add' from the tool bar on the left-hand side of the screen.

2 Select the 'Menu' option.

3 Select the menu style you want to add to your page.

4 A menu will appear on your web page. Drag it into the page header.

To see how your menu works, use the 'Preview' button. This button shows how your pages will look and work in a browser.



Activity

Create a new web page and give it a title. Add two or three images to the page. Add a heading to the body of the page.



Extra challenge

Add a menu to your home page. It should link your home page and your new web page.

Test that the menu works using 'Preview'.

Think again

Create a new page called 'Did you know?'. Research some additional facts about your chosen topic and add them to the page. Test the menu using 'Preview'.

2.6 Check your web pages

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to review your web pages
- how to use a review to improve your web pages.

Reviewing your web pages

It is always important to review, or check, your work when you create a document. It does not create a good impression if there are mistakes in your work.

Checking your spelling

Your web page editor may have a **spellchecker**. The spellchecker will help you check the spelling and punctuation on your pages.



Check your text carefully even if your web editor has a spellchecker. Remember, the spellchecker won't find a word that you have spelt correctly but is not the right word to use in that sentence. For example, 'Robots never get bored by **there** work'. In this example, the correct word is 'their'.

Is your text clear?

Does your text say what you want it to say? It will help the reader if you keep your sentences short. Try to make sure that each sentence makes a single point.

Ask someone else to read your text. They can tell you if anything you have written is confusing.

Images

Here are some things to think about when you review your images.

- Are the images high quality?
- Are the images the right size and in the right place on the page?
- Do the images make the text on the web page clearer? Do they work with the text on the page?

If you have used images by other people, make sure that you give credit to the owners.

How does your page look?



It is important that your website should look good. A modern web page editor will help you to create a professional-looking page. Here are some things to think about when you review your page.

- Have you used fonts and text size consistently? Don't use too many different ones!
- Do the colours you have used go well together? Avoid using too many bright colours.
- Do the headings help you to understand what the page is about?
- Are items on your page too squashed together? Are they too far apart?

Ask someone else to look at your page and answer these questions. They may have ideas that will help you to improve how your pages look.

Do the links work?

Check the links and menus on your pages to make sure they work. It should be clear where links are on your page and where they go to.



Activity

Use the guidelines in this lesson to create a checklist for reviewing a web page. The checklist needs to list the checks you will carry out. For example, 'Check spelling and punctuation'. Write the checklist using a word-processor.

Check your list with a classmate to make sure you haven't missed anything. Use the checklist whenever you are reviewing web pages.



Extra challenge

Work with a partner. Review each other's web pages.

Write a brief review of your partner's website and tell them what changes you think they should make.

Use your partner's review to make the changes you think are needed.



Explore more

Use the checklist to review the home page you have created. Ask someone in your family to take a look, too. Can they suggest ways to make it better? Make any changes you have talked about.



Check what you know

You have learned

- how to act respectfully when using a computer
- how to create a simple web page with text and images
- how to review and improve your web pages.

Test

Think of a web page you have made. Now answer questions about what you did.

1. Describe something you added to the web page.
2. Describe one mistake you found on your web page and how you corrected it.
3. Describe the text and images you used to make the web page.
4. Explain one improvement you made to your web page. How did the change make it better?
5. Describe your choice of headings on your web page. Give reasons for your choices.
6. Explain what changes or improvements you would make to your web page if you had more time.



Activities

Everyone in the class has made a web page. Look at a web page made by someone in your class.

1. Use the web browser to look at the web page. Write a short description of what you see.
2. Write a short evaluation of the web page. Say something you liked about it, and something you would add or change if you could.
3. Use technology to send your feedback. For example, you might send an email or add a comment on the web page.

Self-evaluation

- I answered test questions 1 and 2.
- I completed activity 1. I worked politely when using the computer.
- I answered test questions 1–4.
- I completed activities 1 and 2. I worked responsibly online and with respect for others.
- I answered all the test questions.
- I completed all of the activities. I gave supportive feedback using online technology.

Re-read any parts of the unit you feel unsure about. Try the test and activities again – can you do more this time?

